Gaurav Bhatia

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Professional Summary

SOC Manager with over eleven years of experience in security operations and incident response across banking and telecom environments. Runs a 24x7 SOC with QRadar and Splunk, owns incident response and reporting, and has led digital forensics on complex cases. Combines hands-on investigation experience with team leadership and risk communication.

Technical Skills

SOC Management: 24x7 shift planning, SOC KPIs (MTTD, MTTR), runbooks, escalation matrix, vendor management, hiring and mentoring

SIEM: IBM QRadar (rules, offenses, reference sets), Splunk Enterprise Security, use case design

Incident Response and Forensics: IR lifecycle, Volatility, Autopsy, disk and memory triage, evidence handling

Network Security: Palo Alto and Fortinet firewall logs, IDS and IPS, proxy and DNS analysis, packet analysis

Governance: ISO 27001 controls, PCI DSS evidence, security incident reporting, tabletop exercises

Threat Intelligence: MITRE ATT&CK, threat feeds integration, intelligence-led use cases

Work Experience

SOC Manager - Yamuna Financial Security Services Pvt Ltd

Gurugram, Haryana | Sep 2023 - Present

- Manage a SOC team of 16 analysts across three shifts supporting banking clients; own staffing, training, quality reviews and client reporting.
- Reduced mean time to respond for high-severity incidents from 95 minutes to 52 minutes through revised escalation paths and better playbooks.
- Led response to a business email compromise and fraud attempt, coordinating containment, evidence preservation and client communication within the same day.
- Introduced monthly purple-team exercises with the red team, producing 22 new detection use cases in the first year.

Senior SOC Analyst and IR Lead - Yamuna Financial Security Services Pvt Ltd

Gurugram, Haryana | Jan 2020 - Aug 2023

- Led incident response for severe cases, including a ransomware attempt on a telecom client contained at one file server.
- Built QRadar use cases for lateral movement and data exfiltration, reducing false offenses by 30%.
- Performed disk and memory forensics for insider threat investigations and prepared evidence for legal teams.

SOC Analyst - Gomti Telecom Security Operations Pvt Ltd

Noida, Uttar Pradesh | Apr 2017 - Dec 2019

- Monitored QRadar offenses, investigated phishing and malware cases and prepared weekly security reports.
- Implemented log source onboarding for 40 network and server devices.

Network Security Engineer - Gomti Telecom Security Operations Pvt Ltd

Noida, Uttar Pradesh | Jul 2015 - Mar 2017

- Administered Palo Alto firewall rules and change management; reviewed rulebases to remove 250 unused rules.

Projects

SOC Metrics and Quality Framework

- Problem: Management had limited insight into SOC effectiveness.
- Approach: Defined KPI set, built dashboards in Splunk and introduced monthly case quality sampling.
- Technologies: Splunk, QRadar, Excel
- Results: Case quality score improved from 78% to 91% across a year.

Ransomware Readiness Exercise

- Problem: Clients lacked tested response plans.
- Approach: Designed a tabletop scenario, ran it with IT, legal and business teams and documented improvement actions.
- Technologies: Tabletop exercise design, IR playbooks
- Results: Closed 18 actions including backup isolation and communications templates.

Education

M.Tech, Information Security (part-time), Aravalli Institute of Technology, Gurugram (2018 - 2020) - CGPA 8.2 / 10

B.Tech, Electronics and Communication Engineering, Hindon Institute of Engineering, Noida (2011 - 2015) - CGPA 7.6 / 10

Certifications

- CISSP (2021)
- GIAC Certified Incident Handler (GCIH, 2020)
- IBM Certified QRadar SIEM Analyst
- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH, 2017)

Achievements

- Promoted to SOC Manager in 2023 after leading the incident response function.
- Reduced mean time to respond by 45% in 18 months.